

STUDY NOTES · UPSSSC PET 2026

General English — Reading Comprehension

UPSSSC PET 2026 Detailed Notes · Unseen Passages & PYQ Strategy

01 September 2026

General English

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General English — Reading Comprehension

PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

Focus: Main Idea → Facts → Inference → Vocabulary → Title → Reference → Purpose → Tone → Advanced Question Patterns → Practice

Hindi Help: Short support is provided only for difficult reading logic.



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1. What is Reading Comprehension?

Reading comprehension is the ability to understand a passage, identify important information, interpret the writer's meaning, and answer questions using evidence from the text.

PET comprehension questions may test:

- Main idea / central theme
- Specific facts and details
- Inference and conclusion
- Vocabulary in context
- Synonym/antonym in context
- Suitable title
- Reference of a word/phrase
- Cause and effect
- Sequence/order
- Writer's purpose
- Author's viewpoint
- Tone
- True / False / Not stated style questions
- EXCEPT / NOT / INCORRECT questions
- Sentence-level meaning



Exam Tip

Golden Rule: The passage is the primary source of evidence. Do not select an answer simply because it is generally true or because you already know something about the topic.

2. Question-Type Master Table

Question Type	What it asks	Main approach
Main Idea	central message	whole passage
Central Theme	broad subject/message	repeated idea + conclusion
Detail/Fact	explicitly stated information	locate evidence
Inference	reasonable conclusion	evidence + logic
Vocabulary	meaning in context	surrounding words
Synonym	closest contextual meaning	substitution test
Antonym	opposite contextual meaning	exact contextual sense
Title	best overall heading	main idea + scope
Reference	what a word refers to	grammar + logic
Cause/Effect	reason/result	connectors + relationships
Sequence	first/next/last	time markers
Purpose	why information is included	function of passage
Viewpoint	writer's position	repeated claims + language
Tone	writer's attitude	evaluative language
True/False	whether statement agrees	direct comparison
Not Stated	information absent	evidence check
NOT/EXCEPT	statement that does not fit	verify every option
Sentence Meaning	meaning of a specific line	local + paragraph context

3. How to Read a Passage

Step 1 — Preview

Read the title, opening sentence, and, when useful, scan the question set.

Step 2 — Identify the subject

Ask: **Who/what is this passage about?**

Step 3 — Track the development

Look for:

- topic sentence
- explanation
- evidence
- example
- contrast
- cause/effect
- conclusion

Step 4 — Notice connectors

Important connectors include:

however, therefore, because, although, moreover, consequently, for example, finally.

Step 5 — Build a mental map

Topic → Main claim → Supporting points → Conclusion

∴ strategy **Read → Understand → Locate evidence → Eliminate → Answer**

Do not depend on memory alone when the passage is available. ∴

4. Question-First vs Passage-First Strategy

There is no single method for every passage.

Passage-first

Useful when the passage is short or the topic is unfamiliar.

Question-first

Useful when the passage is longer and questions ask for specific details.

Hybrid Method

For PET, a practical approach is:

1. Quickly understand the topic.
2. Scan the questions.
3. Return to the passage for evidence.
4. Read the relevant paragraph carefully.

Exam Tip

Do not follow a strategy rigidly. **Accuracy and textual evidence matter more than the order in which you read.**

5. Main Idea vs Central Theme

Main idea = the central point the writer communicates.

Central theme = the broader subject or message developed throughout the passage.

Example

A passage discusses how regular exercise improves physical health, mood, sleep, and concentration.

- **Topic:** Exercise
- **Central theme:** Benefits of regular physical activity
- **Main idea:** Regular physical activity has several important benefits for overall well-being.

⚠ Trap

A single example, statistic, person, or minor benefit is usually too narrow to represent the main idea or title.

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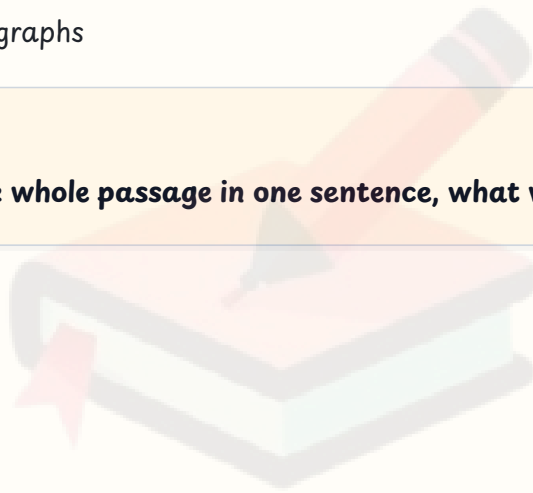
6. Finding the Main Idea

Look for:

1. Repeated concepts
2. Topic sentence
3. Supporting examples
4. Final conclusion
5. Relationship between paragraphs

⚡ Trick

Ask: "If I had to explain the whole passage in one sentence, what would I say?"



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7. Fact and Detail Questions

A fact/detail question asks for information directly stated or clearly presented.

Method

1. Identify the keyword.
2. Locate it or its synonym in the passage.
3. Read the surrounding sentence(s).
4. Match the option with the evidence.
5. Reject options that add unsupported information.

⚠ Warning

A statement may be true in real life but still be wrong if the passage does not support it.

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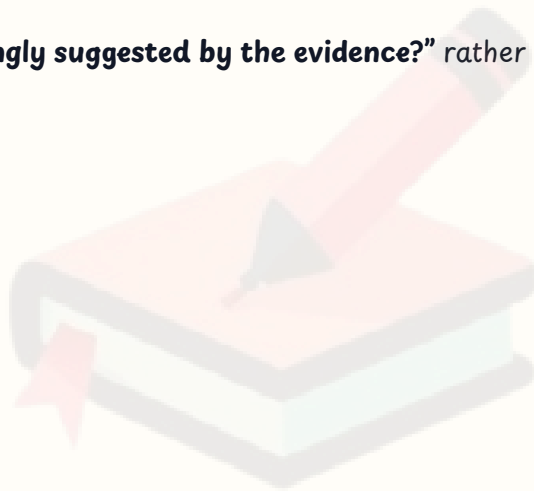
8. Inference Questions

An inference is a conclusion reasonably supported by the passage. It is not a guess or outside knowledge.

Evidence Ladder

Textual fact → logical connection → reasonable conclusion

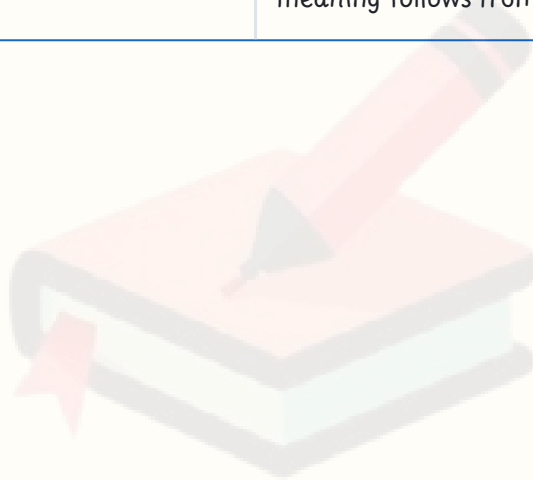
::: strategy Ask: **“What is strongly suggested by the evidence?”** rather than “What could possibly be true?” :::



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9. Direct vs Inferred Information

Direct	Inferred
explicitly stated	logically concluded
little interpretation needed	some reasoning required
words/details appear in text	meaning follows from evidence



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10. Negative Inference Questions

Questions may ask:

- Which cannot be inferred?
- Which is NOT implied?
- Which statement is least supported?

Method

1. Treat every option as a claim.
2. Find evidence for each.
3. Eliminate clearly supported options.
4. Choose the option with no reasonable textual support.

Trap

Do not choose an option merely because it is unlikely in real life. It must be unsupported by the passage.

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11. Vocabulary in Context

A word can have different meanings in different contexts.

Context Method

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Read before and after it.
3. Identify the part of speech.
4. Substitute each option mentally.
5. Choose the meaning that fits the passage.

The scientist **observed** a change in the sample.

Here **observed** means **noticed/watched carefully**.

💡 Exam Tip

Choose the contextual meaning, not the first dictionary meaning you remember.

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12. Synonym and Antonym Questions in a Passage

For passage-based vocabulary questions, do not use an isolated vocabulary list alone.

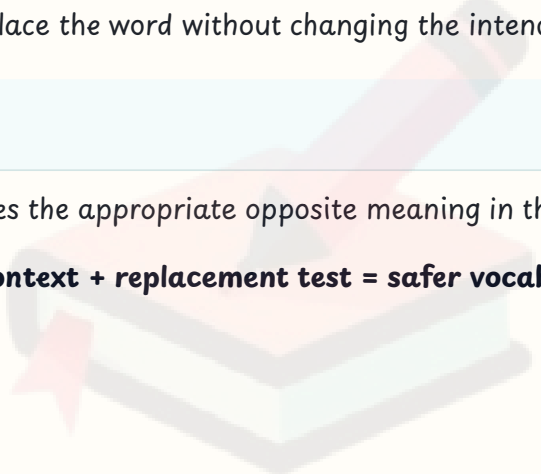
Synonym

Choose the option that can replace the word without changing the intended meaning.

Antonym

Choose the option that expresses the appropriate opposite meaning in that context.

::: strategy **Part of speech + context + replacement test = safer vocabulary answer.** :::



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13. Reference Questions

Common reference words:

- it
- they
- he/she
- this
- that
- these
- those
- such
- former/latter

Method

1. Look backward first.
2. Identify grammatically possible antecedents.
3. Check number/person agreement.
4. Check logical meaning.

The city introduced electric buses. **This** reduced pollution.

This refers to the introduction/use of electric buses described earlier.

⚠️ Trap

The nearest noun is not automatically the correct reference.

14. Suitable Title

The best title should:

- represent the whole passage
- capture the central idea
- be concise
- avoid unsupported information

Title Test

Ask: **“Does this title cover most of the passage, not just one paragraph?”**

⚡ Trick

Best Title ≈ Main Idea in a short form.

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15. Cause and Effect

Common cause markers:

- because
- since
- due to
- owing to
- as

Common effect markers:

- therefore
- hence
- thus
- consequently
- as a result



The river overflowed **because of** continuous rainfall.

Cause → continuous rainfall

Effect → river overflow

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16. Sequence and Chronology

Look for:

- first
- initially
- then
- next
- later
- afterwards
- finally
- eventually

::: strategy Create a simple mental timeline instead of memorising every sentence word-for-word. :::



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17. Writer's Purpose

The writer may intend primarily to:

- inform
- explain
- describe
- compare
- persuade
- warn
- criticize
- suggest
- evaluate

Purpose Test

Ask: **“What job is the passage doing?”**

The purpose should be inferred from the whole passage, not one sentence.

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18. Author's Viewpoint

Viewpoint is the position or perspective from which the writer discusses a subject.

Look for:

- repeated claims
- recommendations
- criticism
- praise
- qualifications
- comparison between alternatives

Exam Tip

Do not infer the author's viewpoint from the topic alone. A passage about technology may be supportive, critical, balanced, or cautious.

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19. Tone

Tone is the writer's attitude.

Common tones:

- neutral
- informative
- positive
- critical
- concerned
- optimistic
- pessimistic
- appreciative
- cautious
- skeptical
- encouraging



Look at adjectives, verbs, evaluations, recommendations, and repeated emotional signals.

⚠ Warning

Topic ≠ Tone. “Pollution” is a topic; “concerned” or “critical” may describe tone.

20. Fact vs Opinion

Fact

Information that can generally be verified.

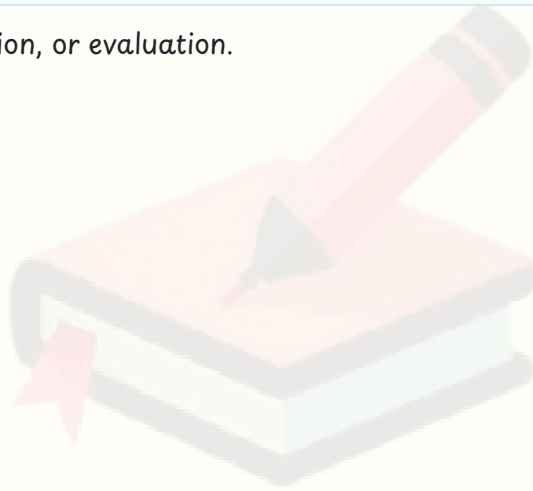
Opinion

Belief, judgment, recommendation, or evaluation.

Possible signals include:

- should
- best
- worst
- excellent
- terrible
- I believe
- in my view

Always judge the complete sentence and context.



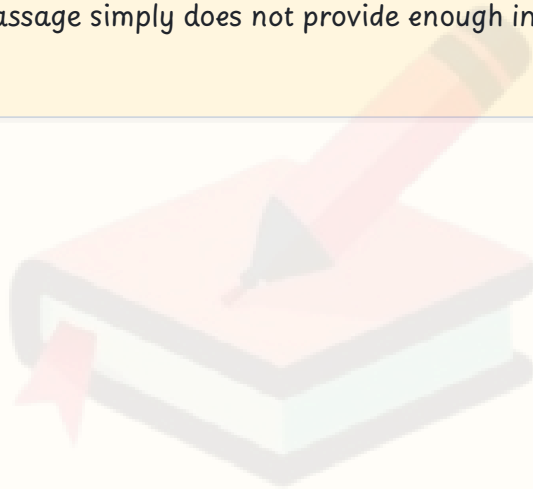
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21. True / False / Not Stated

- **True:** clearly supported by the passage.
- **False:** contradicted by the passage.
- **Not Stated:** neither clearly supported nor contradicted.

⚠ Trap

Not stated $\neq$ false. If the passage simply does not provide enough information, do not invent a contradiction.



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22. NOT / EXCEPT / INCORRECT Questions

Watch for:

- NOT
- EXCEPT
- FALSE
- INCORRECT
- CANNOT
- NOT TRUE

Method

1. Highlight the negative word mentally.
2. Check every option against the passage.
3. Mark supported options.
4. Select the option matching the question's negative requirement.

⚠ Warning

Many mistakes happen because students find a true option when the question actually asks for the false/incorrect one.

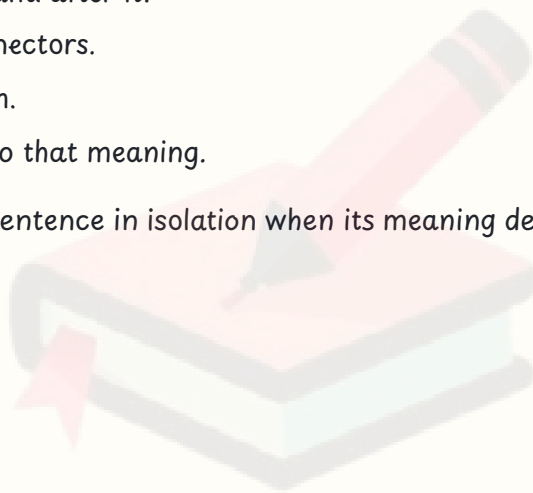
23. Sentence-Level Meaning

Sometimes a question asks what a particular sentence means or implies.

Method

1. Read the target sentence.
2. Read one sentence before and after it.
3. Identify pronouns and connectors.
4. Restate it in simpler English.
5. Choose the option closest to that meaning.

∴ strategy Do not interpret a sentence in isolation when its meaning depends on surrounding context. ∴



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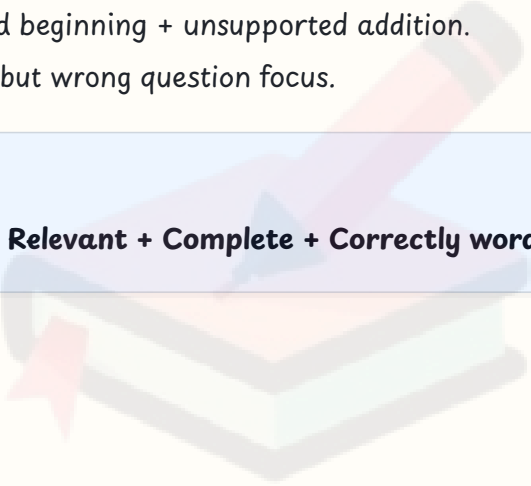
24. Option Elimination

Eliminate options that are:

1. **Contradictory** — passage says the opposite.
2. **Unsupported** — no evidence.
3. **Too extreme** — stronger than the text.
4. **Too narrow** — only one small detail.
5. **Partly correct** — supported beginning + unsupported addition.
6. **Off-topic** — related words but wrong question focus.

Formula

Best answer = Supported + Relevant + Complete + Correctly worded



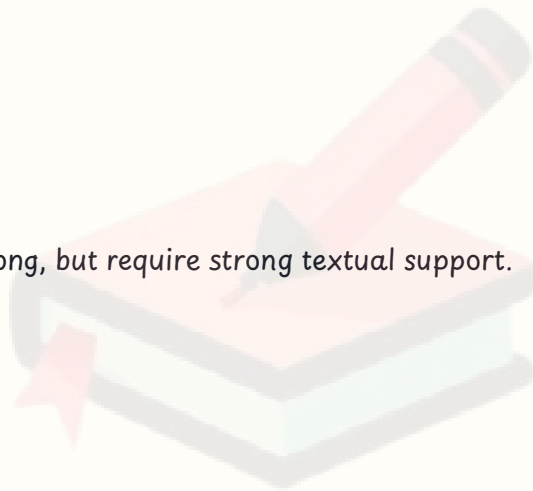
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25. Extreme Words

Be cautious with:

- always
- never
- all
- none
- completely
- only
- must
- impossible

They are not automatically wrong, but require strong textual support.



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26. Paragraph Mapping

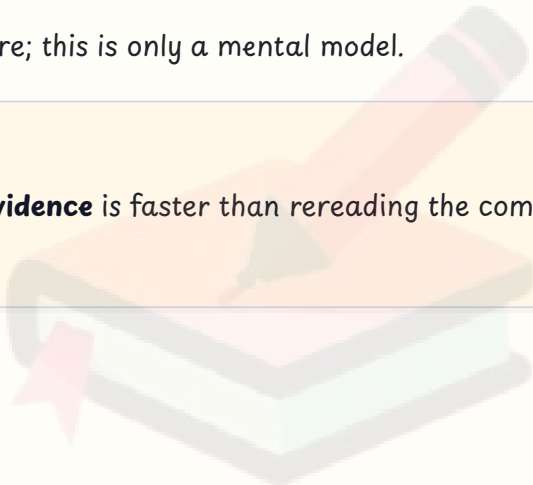
For longer passages, mentally label:

- **P1:** introduction/topic
- **P2:** explanation/evidence
- **P3:** example/contrast
- **P4:** conclusion/solution

Use the actual passage structure; this is only a mental model.

⚡ Trick

Keyword → Paragraph → Evidence is faster than rereading the complete passage for every detail question.



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27. Passage Length Strategy

Short Passage

- Read the complete passage carefully.
- Identify the central idea.
- Answer directly from evidence.

Medium Passage

- Track paragraph purpose.
- Notice contrasts and examples.
- Return to relevant sections.

Long Passage

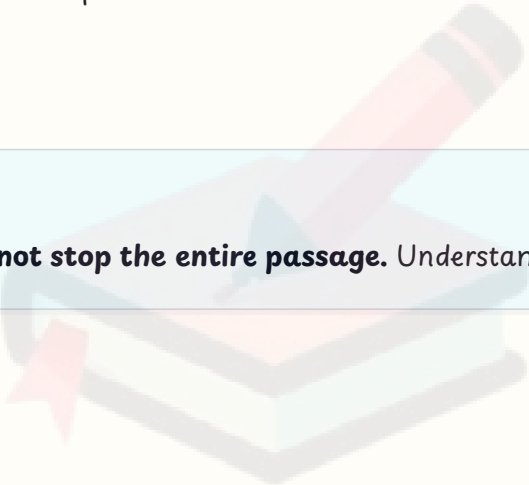
- Build a paragraph map.
- Scan questions for keywords.
- Locate evidence efficiently.
- Avoid unnecessary rereading.

28. Difficult Vocabulary During Reading

You do not need to understand every word.

If a word is unfamiliar:

1. Ignore it temporarily.
2. Read surrounding context.
3. Determine whether it affects the question.
4. Infer meaning if necessary.
5. Return only if required.



Exam Tip

One unknown word should not stop the entire passage. Understand the overall meaning first.

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29. Reading Speed vs Accuracy

Improve speed by:

- reading meaningful word groups
- recognising connectors
- locating keywords
- avoiding unnecessary rereading
- practising regularly

Improve accuracy by:

- checking negative words
- returning to evidence
- separating fact from inference
- rejecting extreme options
- verifying the exact question requirement



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30. Common Comprehension Traps

Trap

Trap 1 — Outside Knowledge

The option is true generally but unsupported by the passage.

Trap 2 — Detail as Main Idea

A minor fact is selected as the central message.

Trap 3 — Extreme Option

The option is stronger than the passage's wording.

Trap 4 — Half-Correct Option

One part is supported, another is invented.

Trap 5 — Reference Error

A nearby noun is selected without checking logic.

Trap 6 — Negative Question

NOT/EXCEPT/INCORRECT is overlooked.

Trap 7 — Not Stated = False

Lack of information is incorrectly treated as contradiction.

Trap 8 — Tone by Topic

The subject is mistaken for the writer's attitude.

31. Hindi Help — Quick Reading Map

Question	Hindi clue
Main Idea	पूरे passage का मुख्य विचार
Theme	passage का व्यापक विषय/संदेश
Fact	passage में सीधे क्या बताया गया?
Inference	जानकारी से क्या निष्कर्ष निकलता है?
Vocabulary	context में word का अर्थ
Title	पूरे passage का सबसे उपयुक्त शीर्षक
Reference	this/it/they किसके लिए है?
Cause	कारण क्या है?
Effect	परिणाम क्या है?
Purpose	writer यह क्यों बता रहा है?
Tone	writer का attitude कैसा है?
Not Stated	passage में जानकारी नहीं दी गई

32. Solved Mini Passage — Main Idea

Passage

Regular physical activity can improve several aspects of health. It can strengthen the body, support better sleep, and improve mood. Even moderate activity, when performed regularly, can contribute to a healthier lifestyle.

Question

What is the main idea?

- A. Sleep is the only benefit of exercise.
- B. Regular physical activity has several health benefits.
- C. Only intense exercise is useful.
- D. Exercise is difficult for everyone.

Answer: B

Why? Several benefits are discussed; sleep is only one detail.

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33. Solved Mini Passage — Inference

Passage

The village had received very little rainfall for several months. The wells were drying up, and farmers had begun using water carefully for crops.

Question

What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. The village was experiencing water scarcity.
- B. The village received record rainfall.
- C. All crops had already failed.
- D. The farmers stopped working completely.

Answer: A

Reason: Low rainfall + drying wells + careful water use support the inference.

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34. Solved Mini Passage — Vocabulary

Passage

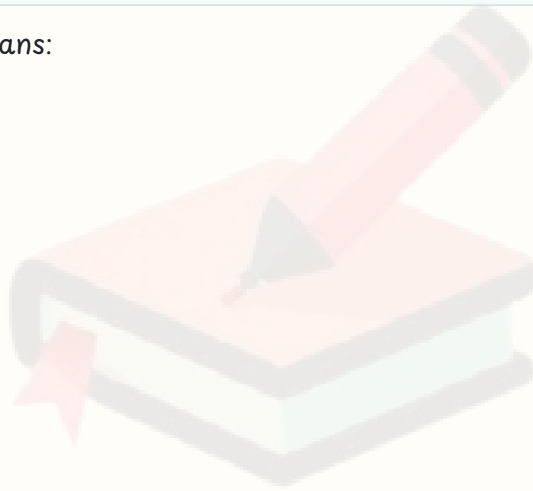
The teacher gave a **brief** explanation before the test began.

Question

The word **brief** most nearly means:

- A. lengthy
- B. short
- C. confusing
- D. difficult

Answer: B



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35. Solved Mini Passage — Reference

Passage

The city planted more trees along major roads. **This** helped reduce dust and improve the local environment.

Question

What does **This** refer to?

- A. major roads
- B. dust
- C. planting more trees
- D. the local environment

Answer: C



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36. Solved Mini Passage — Title

Passage

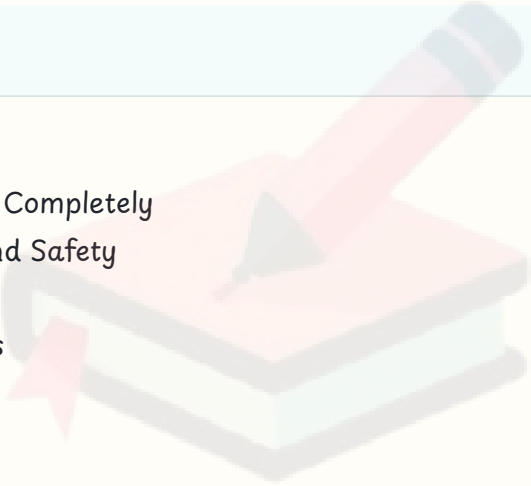
Digital payments have become increasingly common. They can make transactions faster and reduce the need to carry cash. However, users should remain careful about passwords, suspicious links, and fraudulent messages.

Question

Which is the most suitable title?

- A. Why Cash Should Disappear Completely
- B. Digital Payments: Benefits and Safety
- C. The History of Banks
- D. Problems With Mobile Phones

Answer: B



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37. Solved Mini Passage — Not Stated

Passage

The school introduced a reading period every Friday. Students may use the library during this period, and teachers encourage them to choose books according to their interests.

Question

Which statement is **NOT stated**?

- A. The reading period is held every Friday.
- B. Students may use the library.
- C. Teachers encourage students to choose books according to their interests.
- D. Students receive marks for every book they read.

Answer: D

Why? The passage does not mention marks for reading books.

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38. Solved Mini Passage — Tone / Viewpoint

Passage

Online learning can make educational material accessible to students who live far from major institutions. However, reliable internet access and self-discipline remain important challenges. Therefore, online learning can be valuable, but it works best when learners have appropriate support and resources.

Questions

1. What is the writer's viewpoint?

- A. Completely against online learning
- B. Completely in favour without any limitation
- C. Balanced, recognising benefits and challenges
- D. Unrelated to online learning

Answer: C

2. The tone is best described as:

- A. balanced/cautious
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. celebratory

Answer: A

39. Full Practice Passage 1

Passage

Trees play an important role in maintaining a healthy environment. They absorb carbon dioxide, release oxygen, provide shade, and support many forms of wildlife. Trees can also help reduce soil erosion by holding soil together with their roots. In urban areas, planting trees can make streets more comfortable and improve the appearance of public spaces. For these reasons, protecting existing trees and increasing green cover are important environmental measures.

Questions

1. What is the main idea?
 - A. Trees are useful only in cities.
 - B. Trees provide several environmental benefits and should be protected.
 - C. Wildlife is the only reason to plant trees.
 - D. Trees prevent all environmental problems.
2. Which benefit is mentioned?
 - A. Increasing soil erosion
 - B. Reducing oxygen
 - C. Providing shade
 - D. Eliminating all pollution
3. How can trees reduce soil erosion?
 - A. By increasing rainfall
 - B. By holding soil with their roots
 - C. By removing wildlife
 - D. By covering roads
4. What can be inferred about urban trees?
 - A. They can contribute to more comfortable public spaces.
 - B. They are harmful to cities.
 - C. They are useful only for wildlife.
 - D. They have no environmental role.
5. Which title is most suitable?
 - A. The Many Benefits of Trees
 - B. Roads and Buildings

C. Wildlife Without Trees

D. Problems With Soil



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40. Full Practice Passage 2

Passage

Many students believe that studying for long hours automatically produces better results. However, the quality of study is often more important than the number of hours spent at a desk. A focused study session with clear goals, short breaks, and active recall can be more useful than several hours of distracted reading. Regular revision also helps students retain information over time. Therefore, an effective study routine should emphasise concentration, active learning, and consistent revision rather than simply increasing study hours.

Questions

- 6.** What is the main point?
- A. Students should study without breaks.
 - B. Longer study hours always guarantee success.
 - C. Effective study depends on quality, active learning, and consistency.
 - D. Reading is the only useful study method.
- 7.** What may be more useful than distracted reading?
- A. A focused study session with clear goals.
 - B. Studying all night.
 - C. Avoiding revision.
 - D. Increasing distractions.
- 8.** What does active recall represent here?
- A. Passive rereading only.
 - B. An active learning approach.
 - C. Taking longer breaks.
 - D. Avoiding tests.
- 9.** Why is regular revision useful?
- A. It helps retain information over time.
 - B. It eliminates the need to study.
 - C. It increases distractions.
 - D. It makes every session longer.
- 10.** Which title best fits the passage?
- A. Study Longer at Any Cost
 - B. Effective Study: Quality Over Mere Hours

C. Why Students Should Avoid Revision

D. The History of Education



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41. Full Practice Passage 3

Passage

Public libraries continue to serve communities even as digital resources become more widely available. A library provides access to books, newspapers, educational material, and sometimes computers or internet facilities. It can also offer a quiet place for study and learning. For students who may not have suitable study resources at home, such facilities can be especially valuable. Digital technology has changed how people access information, but it has not removed the need for shared public learning spaces.

Questions

- 11.** What is the central idea?
- A. Digital technology has made libraries useless.
 - B. Public libraries continue to provide valuable learning resources and spaces.
 - C. Libraries contain only newspapers.
 - D. Students should never use digital resources.
- 12.** Which facility is mentioned?
- A. Sports stadiums
 - B. Computers or internet facilities
 - C. Hospitals
 - D. Transport services
- 13.** Why may libraries be especially valuable for some students?
- A. They provide suitable study resources and spaces.
 - B. They guarantee exam success.
 - C. They replace teachers completely.
 - D. They prevent access to digital information.
- 14.** What does “such facilities” refer to?
- A. Digital technology only
 - B. Study resources and facilities provided by libraries
 - C. Newspapers only
 - D. Homes
- 15.** Which statement is supported?
- A. Digital resources have completely replaced libraries.
 - B. Libraries can still function as shared public learning spaces.

- C. Libraries are useful only for children.
- D. Libraries provide no access to technology.



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42. Full Practice Passage 4

Passage

Water conservation is not only a responsibility of large institutions. Households can also reduce unnecessary water use through simple habits such as repairing leaking taps, using water carefully while washing, and reusing suitable water for plants. These actions may appear small individually, but when adopted by many households they can reduce wastage significantly. Conservation therefore depends both on public systems and on responsible everyday behaviour.

Questions

16. What is the central message?

- A. Only institutions can conserve water.
- B. Household habits can contribute meaningfully to water conservation.
- C. Water conservation requires expensive technology in every home.
- D. Small actions have no value.

17. Which action is mentioned?

- A. Leaving taps open
- B. Repairing leaking taps
- C. Increasing water wastage
- D. Avoiding plants

18. What can be inferred?

- A. Collective small actions can have a significant effect.
- B. Household behaviour never matters.
- C. Public systems are unnecessary.
- D. Water conservation is impossible.

19. The phrase “these actions” refers to:

- A. public systems only
- B. everyday water-saving habits
- C. institutions
- D. expensive technology

20. Which title is best?

- A. Water Conservation: Everyday Responsibility
- B. Why Water Should Be Wasted

- C. Large Institutions Only
- D. The History of Water



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43. Full Practice Passage 5

Passage

Public transport can reduce the number of private vehicles on roads when it is reliable, affordable, and convenient. Buses and trains can carry many passengers at once, potentially reducing traffic pressure and fuel consumption per passenger. However, simply increasing the number of vehicles is not enough. Public transport systems also require good scheduling, maintenance, safety, and convenient connections so that people are willing to use them regularly.

Questions

21. What is the main idea?

- A. Public transport is useful only when it is expensive.
- B. Effective public transport can reduce road pressure when supported by reliable services.
- C. Private vehicles should never be used.
- D. More buses alone solve every transport problem.

22. Which condition is mentioned as important?

- A. Unreliable service
- B. High fares only
- C. Good scheduling and maintenance
- D. Fewer connections

23. Why can buses and trains reduce traffic pressure?

- A. They carry many passengers at once.
- B. They increase private vehicles.
- C. They stop all road traffic.
- D. They remove the need for roads.

24. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Reliability can affect willingness to use public transport.
- B. Maintenance is important.
- C. Simply increasing vehicle numbers is always sufficient.
- D. Convenient connections can encourage use.

25. The writer's tone is best described as:

- A. balanced and practical
- B. angry

C. humorous

D. completely dismissive



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44. Full Practice Passage 6

Passage

Reading fiction can provide entertainment, but its value may extend beyond relaxation. Stories can expose readers to unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions. By following characters with different experiences, readers may develop greater awareness of how other people think and feel. This does not mean that every story produces the same effect, but regular engagement with varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.

Questions

26. What is the main idea?

- A. Fiction is useful only for entertainment.
- B. Fiction can provide entertainment and may also encourage perspective-taking and empathy.
- C. Every story produces exactly the same effect.
- D. Fiction should replace all other forms of learning.

27. What may stories expose readers to?

- A. Only familiar situations
- B. Unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions
- C. Only factual information
- D. Only historical dates

28. What does “This” in the passage refer to?

- A. Reading only for entertainment
- B. The possibility that stories can develop awareness of other people's perspectives
- C. Every story producing the same effect
- D. Avoiding varied narratives

29. Which statement is supported?

- A. Every fiction reader becomes empathetic.
- B. Varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.
- C. Fiction has no value beyond relaxation.
- D. Stories cannot influence perspective.

30. Which title is most suitable?

- A. Fiction: Entertainment and Perspective
- B. Why Every Story Is Identical

C. Reading Without Reflection

D. The End of Fiction

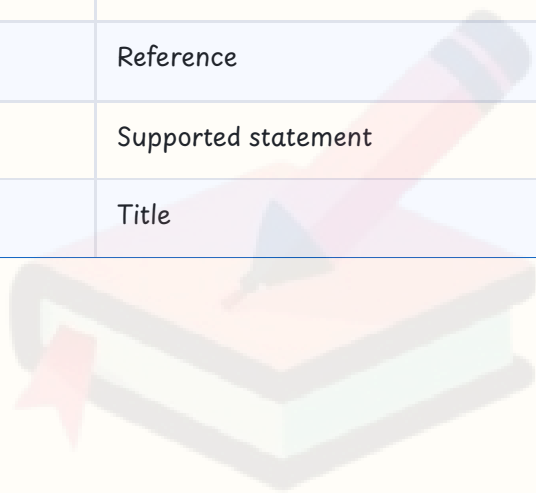


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45. Answer Key — Full Practice

Q	Ans	Skill
1	B	Main idea
2	C	Fact
3	B	Detail
4	A	Inference
5	A	Title
6	C	Main idea
7	A	Detail
8	B	Context
9	A	Detail
10	B	Title
11	B	Main idea
12	B	Fact
13	A	Inference/detail
14	B	Reference
15	B	Supported statement
16	B	Main idea
17	B	Fact
18	A	Inference
19	B	Reference
20	A	Title
21	B	Main idea

Q	Ans	Skill
22	C	Detail
23	A	Cause/effect
24	C	NOT supported
25	A	Tone
26	B	Main idea
27	B	Detail
28	B	Reference
29	B	Supported statement
30	A	Title



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46. Advanced Mixed Practice — Question Patterns

Passage A

Community gardens can transform unused urban spaces into productive and social areas. Residents may grow vegetables, flowers, and herbs while also meeting neighbours and learning basic gardening skills. Such gardens do not solve every urban problem, but they can contribute to local food awareness, community interaction, and greener surroundings.

31. The main idea is:

- A. Community gardens solve every urban problem.
- B. Community gardens can provide several environmental and social benefits.
- C. Urban residents should grow only vegetables.
- D. Gardening is mainly a commercial activity.

32. What does “**Such gardens**” refer to?

- A. unused spaces
- B. community gardens
- C. urban problems
- D. vegetables

33. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Gardens may encourage interaction among residents.
- B. Gardens may provide learning opportunities.
- C. Gardens completely solve urban problems.
- D. Gardens can make surroundings greener.

34. The writer's viewpoint is best described as:

- A. positive but qualified
- B. completely negative
- C. unrelated
- D. sarcastic

Passage B

Many people assume that taking notes means writing down nearly everything a speaker says. Effective notes, however, usually involve selecting important ideas, organising them clearly, and using short forms where appropriate. The purpose of note-taking is not to create a complete transcript but to create a useful record that helps later recall.

35. What is the main point?

- A. Every spoken word should be written down.
- B. Effective note-taking involves selecting and organising important information.
- C. Short forms should never be used.
- D. Note-taking is unnecessary.

36. What does “however” signal?

- A. addition
- B. contrast
- C. cause
- D. sequence

37. According to the passage, the purpose of note-taking is to:

- A. create a complete transcript
- B. help later recall through a useful record
- C. copy every sentence exactly
- D. avoid organising information

38. Which statement is most strongly supported?

- A. More words always mean better notes.
- B. Selective notes can be more useful than a complete transcript.
- C. Note-taking requires no judgment.
- D. Speakers should pause after every sentence.

Passage C

A town introduced a bicycle-sharing programme near major transit stations. During the first few months, usage was modest because many residents were unfamiliar with the system. After clearer signs were installed and information about membership became easier to access, more people began using the bicycles. The change suggests that convenience and information can influence whether people adopt a new public service.

39. Why was early usage modest?

- A. Bicycles were unavailable.
- B. Residents were unfamiliar with the system.
- C. Transit stations were closed.
- D. Membership was compulsory.

40. What happened after clearer signs and information were provided?

- A. Usage increased.
- B. The programme ended.
- C. Stations were removed.
- D. Residents stopped cycling.

41. What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. Information and convenience may affect adoption of a service.
- B. All residents prefer bicycles.
- C. Signs alone guarantee success.
- D. Public services never need promotion.

42. Which title is most suitable?

- A. Factors Affecting Adoption of a Bicycle-Sharing Service
- B. Why Bicycles Are Dangerous
- C. The History of Transit Stations
- D. Membership Fees Only

Passage D

A museum exhibition compared traditional tools with modern automated equipment. Rather than presenting one as universally superior, the exhibition showed how different tools suit different tasks. Traditional tools may offer simplicity and direct control, while automated systems can increase speed and consistency. The exhibition therefore encouraged visitors to think about suitability rather than assuming that newer technology is always better.

43. What is the central message?

- A. Traditional tools are always better.
- B. Modern equipment is always better.
- C. The appropriate tool depends on the task.
- D. Museums should avoid technology.

44. The tone is:

- A. balanced and analytical
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. fearful

45. What does “**one**” refer to in “Rather than presenting one as universally superior”?

- A. one task
- B. either type of tool
- C. one museum
- D. one visitor

46. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Traditional tools may provide direct control.
- B. Automated systems may increase speed.
- C. Newer technology is always better.
- D. Different tasks may require different tools.



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47. Advanced Practice Answer Key

Q	Ans	Skill
31	B	Main idea
32	B	Reference
33	C	NOT supported
34	A	Viewpoint/tone
35	B	Main idea
36	B	Connector/contrast
37	B	Detail
38	B	Inference
39	B	Fact
40	A	Fact
41	A	Inference
42	A	Title
43	C	Central message
44	A	Tone
45	B	Reference
46	C	NOT supported

48. Final Reading Strategy

Remember

Before reading

Understand the topic and question requirement.

While reading

Follow the main idea, paragraph purpose, connectors, examples, contrasts, and conclusions.

While answering

Locate evidence, eliminate unsupported/extreme options, and distinguish fact from inference.

Before marking

Check whether the question asks **TRUE, FALSE, NOT, EXCEPT, or INCORRECT**.

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49. Quick Revision Checklist

- ☐ Identify the main idea.
- ☐ Distinguish main idea from central theme.
- ☐ Separate main idea from supporting details.
- ☐ Locate explicit facts.
- ☐ Make only evidence-based inferences.
- ☐ Handle negative inference questions carefully.
- ☐ Use context for vocabulary.
- ☐ Solve contextual synonym/antonym questions.
- ☐ Trace pronoun/reference words.
- ☐ Select a title covering the whole passage.
- ☐ Identify cause and effect.
- ☐ Follow chronological order.
- ☐ Identify writer's purpose and viewpoint.
- ☐ Recognise tone.
- ☐ Distinguish fact, opinion, and not-stated information.
- ☐ Watch negative question words.
- ☐ Eliminate extreme/unsupported options.
- ☐ Adjust strategy according to passage length.

Formula

Reading Comprehension Formula:

Understand → Map → Locate evidence → Eliminate traps → Verify → Answer

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